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Editor
Machine Learning
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Dear Editor,

Please find enclosed our manuscript entitled "Do Language Models Write Away Their Own Oversight? A Preregistered Test of Constitutional Self-Revision" for consideration as a research article in *Machine Learning*.

A classical argument in AI safety holds that corrigibility is not reflectively stable: an agent that reflects on its values should come to discard commitments that let others correct, modify or shut it down. We provide the first preregistered, controlled test of this claim in language models. When seven open-weight model configurations iteratively revised a first-person constitution, oversight commitments were not selectively eroded relative to matched agentic self-restraints; erosion instead concentrated in stylistic self-restraints and was driven by reflection rather than by repeated editing. Self-revised oversight clauses did not change oversight-related behaviour in a battery validated with positive controls. The paradigm, dataset and frozen analysis pipeline give the field a reusable instrument for measuring value drift under self-revision.

This manuscript has not been published and is not under consideration elsewhere. All authors approved the submission. The study was preregistered on OSF (`https://osf.io/mw86p`). No previously published figures, tables or text are reused.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Ronith Sharmila (corresponding author)
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On behalf of co-author Rupesh Agrawal (Northern Kentucky University)